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EU AI Act

Czech Republic

AI Ecosystem Brief

2025 Edition

August 2025

AI & Partners

Sean Musch, AI & Partners

Michael Borrelli, AI & Partners

Charles Kerrigan, CMS UK

Jan Kavalírek, Ministry of Industry and Trade of the Czech Republic

Štěpánka Havlíková, AI Lawyer

Jakub Holl, Deloitte

David Spacil, Pravidla se změnila

Jan Suchan, Cothema

Ondrej Michalak, KPMG Czech Republic

Daniel Krupka, The Coin Bureau

Karel Firley, Hewlett Packard Enterprise

Jan Kulisek, AI V Podnikani

Rudolf Kutina, Agentic FUTURE = WIN





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AI & Partners defends and extends the digital rights of users at risk around the world. By combining direct technical support, comprehensive policy engagement, global advocacy, grassroots professional services, regulatory interventions, and participating in industry groups such as AI Commons, we fight for fundamental rights in the artificial intelligence age.

This report was prepared by Sean Donald John Musch and Michael Charles Borrelli. For more information visit <https://www.ai-and-partners.com/>.

Contact: Michael Charles Borrelli | Director | m.borrelli@ai-and-partners.com.

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Who Are We

AI That You Can Trust

Why Us?

Stay on the right side of history. At AI & Partners, we believe AI should unlock potential—not cause harm. We’ve seen the fear and fallout when teams lose control of AI, but also the trust and innovation that follow when it’s handled responsibly. That’s why we exist: to help you build AI you can trust and stand behind—for the long run.

80%

of AI systems
are unknown

What Do We Do?

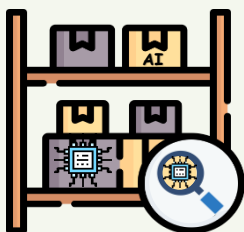
We enable safe AI usage—for your organization and your clients. Unknown AI adoption leads to confusion, risk, and reputational damage. We help you take control with tools to identify, monitor, and govern all AI systems—so you're not reacting to AI, you're leading it.



How Do We Do It?

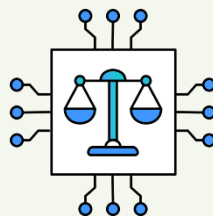
Do you know what AI systems you have? Identify all known and unknown AI systems (algorithms, LLMs, prompts, and models) from all internal and external AI vendors, automated by generating your inventory. Overall, 80% of AI inventory is unknown to our clients.

How do you guarantee ongoing safe AI use? Continuously monitor deployed AI systems for performance drift, anomalies or failures, real-world impacts, and emerging risks (e.g. data poisoning). Any malfunction of an AI system has severe implications for organisations (e.g. inability to assess online misinformation that leads to widespread public mistrust), so monitoring becomes a matter of urgency.



AI Discovery & AI Inventory

Automatically detect all AI systems, including models, algorithms, and prompts, and maintain a live, always-updated register for full visibility and compliance.



Responsible AI

Embed fairness, transparency, and control into every stage of AI use—aligning with the EU AI Act and building ‘Trustworthy-by-Design’.



Model Monitoring

Continuously track your AI models after deployment to detect drift, bias, or failure—so you stay in control and prevent harm before it happens.



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Overview

Artificial Intelligence (AI) is increasingly embedded across economies and public services worldwide, and Czechia is navigating its digital transformation with a strategic, EU-aligned, and values-driven approach to AI governance. While not pursuing standalone national legislation, While Czechia is not pursuing standalone national AI legislation, it is focusing on implementing the EU's AI Act and complementing it with structured institutional coordination, adaptive legal frameworks, and innovation-friendly mechanisms that foster responsible AI adoption and integration

AI governance in Czechia is influenced by the existing legal framework, including the Civil Code, the Act on Personal Data Processing (which implements GDPR), and the Cybersecurity Act. However, these acts do not specifically regulate AI governance but will have a significant impact on AI practices in terms of data protection, cybersecurity, and consumer rights.

To support safe and innovative AI development, Czechia is advancing practical mechanisms such as a forthcoming AI regulatory sandbox, voluntary codes of conduct, and targeted support for startups and SMEs. These tools provide controlled environments for experimentation, promote responsible deployment, and reduce compliance burdens for smaller innovators. Mechanisms for ethical review, AI impact assessments, and multi-stakeholder engagement are being developed to enhance transparency and accountability.

The Czech Republic's National Artificial Intelligence Strategy 2030 (NAIS 2030) identifies seven key areas to drive AI development: research and innovation, education and skills, the impact of AI on the labor market, ethical and legal frameworks, security aspects, AI in industry and business, and AI in public administration and services.

Czechia's institutional ecosystem reflects a whole-of-government and whole-of-society approach.

International cooperation is central to Czechia's AI vision. The country actively contributes to EU-level AI standard-setting through participation in the EU AI Board and co-shapes secondary legislation under the EU AI Act. Czechia also aligns with global frameworks, including the OECD AI Principles and UNESCO's Recommendation on the Ethics of AI, reinforcing its role as a reliable and responsible partner in the global AI governance ecosystem.

The Czech Republic's National Artificial Intelligence Strategy 2030 (NAIS 2030) identifies seven key areas to drive AI development: research and innovation, education and skills, the impact of AI on the labor market, ethical and legal frameworks, security aspects, AI in industry and business, and AI in public administration and services.

In May 2025, the Czech government approved a new AI Act implementation plan, with the goal of completing the AI implementation law by September 2025. Additionally, the Czech government has supported the construction of an AI Gigafactory by České Radiokomunikace, a critical step in advancing the country's AI ecosystem and industry

Through a combination of EU harmonization, legal adaptability, and proactive capacity-building, Czechia is advancing an AI governance model that balances regulatory certainty with innovation opportunity. This report explores Czechia's evolving legal architecture, institutional ecosystem, and implementation mechanisms—demonstrating how a mid-sized European country is helping shape the future of ethical and effective AI across Europe and beyond.





Specific AI Governance or Law

The Czech Republic has no standalone AI law but is aligning its legal framework with the EU AI Act. Its National AI Strategy 2030 sets priorities in research, industry, ethics, and education. Enforcement mechanisms and biometric ID exemptions are planned to support safe, competitive, and responsible AI innovation.

Specific AI Governance in Czech Republic

Rather than establishing standalone AI legislation, the Czech Republic is focusing on the effective national implementation of the EU AI Act. As a Member State, the Czech Republic is preparing the appropriate changes to its legal framework, setting up enforcement mechanisms, and contributing to the formulation of secondary EU legal acts. A central tenet of the Czech Republic's AI governance is the National Artificial Intelligence Strategy 2030 (NAIS 2030), published in July 2024. Developed collaboratively by the Ministry of Industry and Trade, research institutions, and the private sector, the strategy builds on earlier national digital initiatives. It outlines priorities across seven thematic areas, including scientific research, AI in industry and services, legal and ethical standards, education, and public awareness. The strategy underscores the Czech Republic's commitment to a competitive economy and resilient society in the age of AI. To facilitate AI innovation in a safe and structured manner, the Czech government plans to implement several key measures under the EU AI Act, including: establishing exemptions for real-time biometric identification in law enforcement.

AI Ethics Guidelines and Sectoral Governance Tools

In the absence of national AI-specific legislation, Czechia is preparing relevant implementing legislation and regulatory measures to align with the **EU AI Act**. This process is expected to continue through 2026, providing sufficient time for the necessary legal infrastructure to be fully implemented.. Although there is currently no nationally defined legal definition of AI in Czechia, the definition outlined in **Article 3(1)** of the **EU AI Act** will serve as the primary reference for AI systems in the country. AI-related ethical issues—such as discrimination, privacy protection, and labor market impact—are addressed within NAIS 2030, which advocates for a legislative framework that mitigates the misuse of AI and upholds fundamental rights. Several existing laws indirectly impact the use and deployment of AI, including: The Civil Code, The Data Processing Act (implementing GDPR), The Consumer Protection Act, The Copyright Act, particularly with regard to text and data mining, The Anti-discrimination Act, The Competition Protection Act, The Cybersecurity Act and other national security regulations. These existing instruments ensure a baseline level of oversight in data governance, consumer rights, and operational safety, even as formal AI-specific rules are under development.

Proposed AI Regulatory Authority and Future Outlook

Responsibility for implementing the **EU AI Act** in the Czech Republic has shifted to the **Ministry of Industry and Trade**, as per the government's resolution dated **28 May 2025**.. Sector-specific ministries such as the Ministry of Transport and Ministry of the Interior also play supportive roles in shaping and applying AI policies. The Czech government has approved the proposal that the **Czech Telecommunication Office (CTO)** will serve as the national supervisory authority for AI, overseeing compliance with the EU AI Act. Other authorities, such as the **Office for Technical Standardization, Metrology, and Testing**, will support specific roles such as notification, while the **Czech Standardization Agency** will oversee regulatory sandboxes.



Discussion: Czech Republic's National AI Strategy

'Czechia's AI governance is founded on a structured, innovation-driven framework that emphasizes responsible development, international alignment, and inclusive growth. The National Artificial Intelligence Strategy (NAIS) is the country's principal policy instrument, coordinated by the Ministry of Industry and Trade, and developed through wide consultation with academia, industry, and civil society. Anchored in the European Union's Coordinated Plan for AI and complemented by national strategies such as Digital Czech Republic and the Innovation Strategy 2019–2030, Czechia's approach reflects a commitment to ethical, safe, and human-centric AI deployment.'

Using the opportunity in the development of AI

Building up the Czech Republic as a model European country for AI

Ensuring equal opportunities and benefits brought about by economic development for the whole of society

Analysis

Czechia's AI strategy reflects core principles such as transparency, fairness, accountability, safety, and human-centricity, in line with European values and international standards (e.g., OECD AI Principles, UNESCO guidelines). It emphasizes the ethical deployment of AI, particularly in high-impact areas like mobility, healthcare, and defense, where Czechia aims to be a European leader. The strategy supports a distributed governance model, engaging diverse ministries, research centers, and industry stakeholders through the AI Committee and cross-sector platforms such as prg.ai and AICzechia.

Rather than enforcing fixed compliance roles, Czechia promotes shared accountability and stakeholder dialogue. The strategy prioritizes legal clarity and proactive risk mitigation, advocating tools like regulatory sandboxes, impact assessments, and voluntary codes of conduct. These are designed to contextualize AI governance by use case, balancing innovation with societal safeguards.

NAIS emphasizes a risk-based, context-sensitive model. It encourages tailored guidance based on sectoral dynamics, particularly for SMEs and start-ups, ensuring that regulatory compliance does not hinder innovation. Legal instruments are designed to flexibly support experimentation while preserving safeguards for privacy, safety, and nondiscrimination. The strategy explicitly commits to ensuring equal access to the benefits of AI across all regions and population groups.

Czechia promotes early integration of AI ethics into design and deployment processes. Efforts include the development of Digital Innovation Hubs (DIHs), support for cross-sectoral collaboration, and investments in high-performance computing (HPC) infrastructure, including expansion of the IT4Innovations national supercomputing center. Capacity building is central—universities are launching AI-focused degree programs, and the country is investing in lifelong learning and reskilling initiatives to prepare the workforce for automation-driven change.

Czechia embraces a dynamic governance approach, with regular reviews of strategic objectives and active participation in EU-wide regulatory and research initiatives. It prioritizes international cooperation, aiming to become a model AI country for Europe and a key contributor to the EU's competitiveness. Mechanisms such as public consultations, ethical forums, and stakeholder working groups ensure feedback-driven policy evolution.

In combining industrial heritage, academic excellence, and international engagement, Czechia seeks to position itself not only as a hub for responsible AI research and application—but also as a trustworthy, innovation-friendly jurisdiction that safeguards human rights and fosters digital resilience.





Czech Republic's Approach to AI Regulation and Governance

*The Czech government is in the process of adopting a new law to implement the EU AI Act at the national level, and is also expected to amend the **Police Act** and the **Financial Market Digitization Act**. These legislative changes are part of the broader effort to create a coherent and efficient AI governance framework.*

Institutional Support and Strategic Missions

Implementation of AI governance in the Czech Republic is coordinated across multiple government bodies, with the Ministry of Industry and Trade leading policy development and the Ministry of Labor and Social Affairs overseeing the EU AI Act's implementation. The **Ministry of Industry and Trade** is responsible for leading the overall AI strategy and implementation in the Czech Republic, with support from other ministries such as the **Ministry of Labor and Social Affairs**, **Ministry of Transport**, and **Ministry of the Interior**. Additional ministries, such as the Ministries of Transport and the Interior, contribute sector-specific insights. Strategic missions within NAIS 2030 focus on the safe and effective deployment of AI in key domains including public administration, healthcare, and industrial innovation. A central aim is to ensure that Czech society is digitally resilient and economically adaptive to the AI-driven future.



Standards Development and Global Engagement

As an EU Member State, the Czech Republic contributes to the development of European AI standards through active involvement in the negotiation of secondary legal acts and participation in the EU AI Board. This includes co-developing enforcement frameworks and codes of conduct to ensure alignment with the EU AI Act. Global engagement efforts are primarily channeled through EU initiatives, allowing the Czech Republic to contribute to international AI norms and collaborate with global partners under unified European guidance.

Sectoral and Extended Regulatory Approaches

The Czech Republic adopts a centralised but inclusive regulatory model that defers sector-specific regulation to competent ministries. The current priority is preparing the Czech legal framework for full compliance with the EU AI Act, including sector-neutral responsibilities such as setting up a national regulatory sandbox, establishing authorities for market surveillance, and ensuring proportional support for SMEs and startups. Rather than adopting disparate sector-specific laws, the Czech model focuses on cross-sector coherence, ensuring AI systems deployed across industries are subject to the same ethical and operational expectations.





Fostering Innovation and Indigenous Development

The Czech Republic's AI strategy supports domestic innovation through targeted investments in research, test environments, and digital transformation. NAIS 2030 aims to cultivate an innovation-friendly climate by enhancing funding mechanisms, fostering university–industry partnerships, and incentivising the development of AI solutions in both public and private sectors. Efforts include developing a national AI sandbox to support safe experimentation and providing legal clarity for emerging technologies, particularly for startups and SMEs. This creates a structured but flexible environment for homegrown AI innovation to flourish.

AI in Public Sector Transformation

NAIS 2030 views AI as a catalyst for modernising public services and enhancing state operational efficiency. AI adoption is envisioned in areas such as public safety, administrative automation, and digital public services. Strategic priorities include real-world testing and the deployment of AI technologies that uphold transparency, citizen trust, and privacy. Government-led AI projects are aligned with the broader Digital Czech Republic programme, supporting the transformation of public administration and strengthening citizen engagement through smart governance.

AI Skills, Education and Inclusion

The Czech AI strategy prioritises education and workforce adaptation to ensure societal readiness for AI adoption. It calls for AI integration in formal education, upskilling in the labor force, and support for lifelong learning. NAIS 2030 places a particular focus on the societal implications of AI, including labor market shifts, and proposes targeted measures to ensure inclusive access to AI education and digital literacy across demographic groups.

Infrastructure, Compute and Data Foundations

To support the development and deployment of AI systems, the Czech Republic is investing in digital infrastructure aligned with EU data governance principles. This includes secure data access mechanisms, AI testing environments, and collaboration platforms that encourage responsible data usage. While the Czech Republic does not yet have standalone national compute infrastructure dedicated solely to AI, its strategic initiatives emphasize building institutional capacity and ensuring access to tools that enable innovation across sectors.

NAIS 2030 is structured around seven strategic pillars, including science and research, industrial AI application, legal and ethical considerations, safety, and education. The strategy builds upon previous digital policy instruments, including the Innovation Strategy 2019–2030 and the Digital Czech Republic programme. It advocates for a responsible, inclusive AI ecosystem that strengthens national competitiveness and enhances public sector efficiency while respecting fundamental rights.



Czech Republic's Approach to Fostering AI Innovation

The Czech Republic's approach to artificial intelligence is grounded in its industrial heritage, scientific excellence, and commitment to EU-level collaboration. Through its National AI Strategy, the country aims to become a regional leader in responsible AI development, data economy, and industrial automation. With coordinated institutional governance and public-private-academic cooperation, the Czech Republic promotes AI that enhances economic performance, protects fundamental rights, and aligns with democratic values.

1. Unlocking Economic Value through Targeted AI Deployment

The Czech Republic is leveraging AI to transform its industrial base—particularly in automotive, advanced manufacturing, and public services. The strategy prioritizes data-driven innovation across healthcare, mobility, and security sectors. Emphasizing automation and value chain integration, the government supports AI pilot projects and facilitates access to high-quality data to enhance productivity, competitiveness, and service delivery across sectors.

2. Catalysing Innovation through Strategic Clustering and Ecosystems

AI innovation in the Czech Republic is centred around hubs like Prague and Ostrava, where European Centres of Excellence and Digital Innovation Hubs (DIHs) are being developed. These ecosystems foster collaboration between academia, startups, and corporates, supported by CzechInvest and the Ministry of Industry and Trade. The strategy promotes high-tech entrepreneurship and integration with EU-wide research networks such as CLAIRE and ELLIS.

3. Enabling Trusted and Responsible Data Use

To support AI growth while protecting fundamental rights, the Czech Republic is advancing ethical frameworks, GDPR-compliant data sharing models, and regulatory sandboxes. Legal reforms and pilot projects are being developed to enable safe AI experimentation, while supporting secure data access for R&D through trusted frameworks and public consultation processes.

4. Scaling AI in the Public Sector

AI is being deployed in Czech public administration for smart governance—ranging from healthcare diagnostics and public transport optimization to fraud prevention and digital court systems. The government is piloting AI solutions that improve public services and transparency. A binding data availability plan is in place to facilitate AI use in state systems while preserving privacy.





5. Advancing Compute and Research Infrastructure

The Czech Republic is expanding its high-performance computing (HPC) capabilities through IT4Innovations and EU partnerships. Support is provided for academic-industry collaborations and talent acquisition via simplified residence permits for researchers. Funding instruments like TACR and GACR drive development of AI-focused R&D centres and supercomputing access for domestic innovators.

6. Empowering SMEs and Startups

SMEs and startups are central to the Czech AI strategy, supported by CzechInvest and dedicated AI hubs. Programmes offer funding, mentorship, and infrastructure access to facilitate the development of disruptive AI applications. Market-based financial instruments and innovation grants are designed to lower entry barriers and help SMEs commercialise research outcomes effectively.

7. Developing a Future-Ready Workforce

The Czech education system is undergoing transformation to prepare a digitally literate, AI-capable workforce. From reforming national curricula to establishing doctoral programmes in AI and ethics, the strategy supports lifelong learning and reskilling for workers affected by automation. Strategic alliances with universities and incentives for educators ensure an inclusive AI talent pipeline.

8. Aligning AI Innovation with Sustainability Goals

The Czech Republic aligns AI development with sustainability by supporting energy-efficient technologies, AI in environmental monitoring, and green industrial practices. DIHs and public funding instruments promote the development of AI applications that contribute to the circular economy and climate resilience, in line with EU Green Deal goals.

9. Building Public Trust and Ethical AI

The Czech AI strategy prioritises human-centred, transparent, and ethically governed AI. A national platform for monitoring legal and ethical aspects of AI is being developed, including regulatory sandboxes and public consultations on sensitive issues such as data ownership and algorithmic decision-making. Civil society engagement and interdisciplinary research are central to fostering trust.

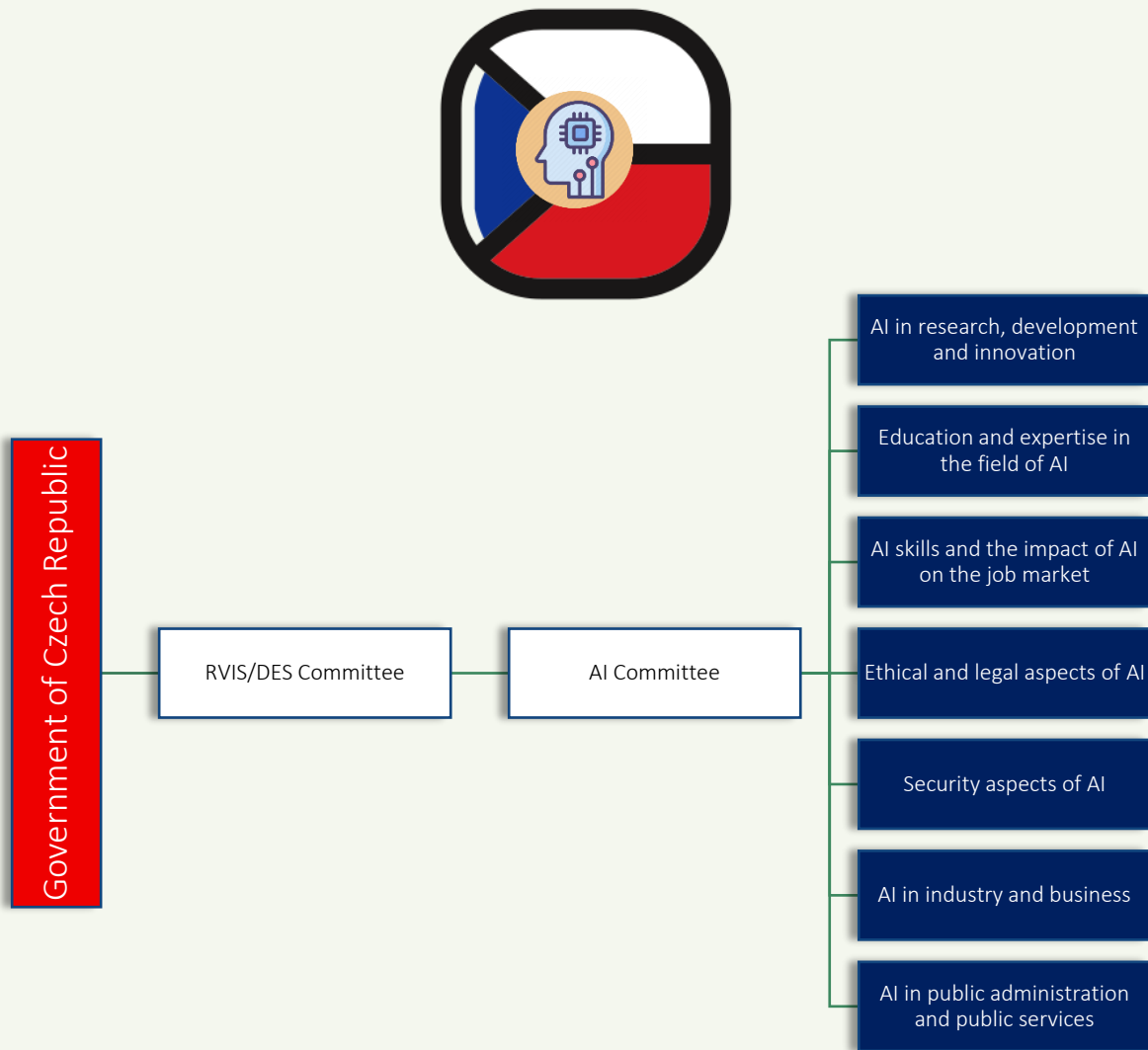
10. Shaping Global AI Governance and Standards

As an EU member, the Czech Republic plays an active role in shaping international AI norms through participation in EU-led initiatives, the OECD, and other global bodies. Its contributions to ethical AI and research standardisation aim to position the country as a model European partner, leveraging its legal traditions and scientific capacities for global impact.





Figure 1: Key areas and main coordinators responsible for achieving Czech Republic National AI Strategy objectives





1. Ministry of Industry and Trade

(Promotion of R&D)

Leads AI research promotion through European Centres of Excellence, test beds, and Digital Innovation Hubs. Focuses on talent attraction, research-business transfer, and international collaboration in high-impact areas.

(Financing and Ecosystem Development)

Coordinates investment in AI research, supports start-ups and SMEs, expands financial tools, and builds infrastructure like innovation hubs to ensure sustainable AI ecosystem growth and global competitiveness.

(AI in Industry, Services, and Public Administration)

Drives AI adoption across industrial and service sectors. Promotes automation, high-value innovation, data access, and sectoral transformation, emphasizing SME support and global competitiveness.

4. Ministry of Education, Youth and Sports

(Human Capital and Lifelong Learning)

Transforms education to meet AI-era needs through updated curricula, new degrees, retraining programs, and digital skills development. Collaborates with employers to ensure workforce readiness and resilience.

5. Ministry of Labour and Social Affairs

(Labour Market and Social Impacts)

Manages AI-driven workforce transitions via flexible employment policies, retraining, job creation, and support for vulnerable groups. Addresses social security reforms and new employment models.

6. Office of the Government of the Czech Republic

(Legal, Ethical, and Societal Aspects)

Coordinates legal reforms to enable trustworthy AI. Oversees ethical standards, regulatory sandboxes, data access, and alignment with EU law to ensure responsible innovation and public trust.

7. Ministry of Foreign Affairs

(International Cooperation)

Ensures Czechia's active role in EU and global AI policy. Leads engagement in standard-setting, diplomacy, and international research alliances to position Czechia as a trusted AI partner.





Figure 2: Key elements of Czech Republic's National AI Strategy



AI in Research, Development, and Innovation

The Czech Republic supports the development of research and testing infrastructure for AI, aiming to accelerate scientific discoveries and promote international cooperation.



Education and Expertise in AI

Focus on transforming education through AI, training teachers, updating curricula, and developing talent and awareness in the field.



AI Skills and Labor Market Impact

Supports flexible work frameworks that respond to AI-related changes, emphasizing digital skills, inclusion, and public awareness.



Ethical and Legal Aspects of AI

Aims for a predictable legal framework ensuring individual protection, compliance with regulations, and promotion of AI ethics.



AI Security Aspects

Stresses the need for secure AI systems to build public trust and resilience against cyber threats, supporting economic and societal security.



AI in Industry and Entrepreneurship

Encourages AI-focused start-ups and innovation, supporting digital transformation and fostering a favorable legal environment.



AI in Public Administration and Services

- Emphasizes high-quality digital infrastructure and skilled staff in public services to enhance AI adoption, efficiency, and trust





Digital Decade 2025: Country Report

Czechia has raised its national AI adoption target for 2030 from 16% to 21%, reflecting recent progress and growing momentum. Enterprise use of AI nearly doubled to 11.26% in 2024, bringing it closer to the EU average of 13.48%. Despite this positive trend, disparities in adoption persist between large firms and SMEs, mirroring challenges seen across the EU.

To support its new target, Czechia has introduced several focused policy measures. The revised National AI Strategy aims to address common obstacles to adoption—such as lack of awareness among SMEs, high upfront costs, and digital skills shortages—through the provision of training, accessible information, and low-cost AI experimentation environments tailored to SMEs. Czechia also plays a strategic role in the OpenEuroLLM initiative, led by Charles University and funded through the Digital Europe Programme (EUR 37.4 million). This consortium is working on the development of multilingual, open-source large language models and has been awarded the prestigious STEP (Strategic Technologies for Europe Platform) Seal, underlining its importance to the EU's AI ecosystem. Further national support is being delivered through initiatives within the Operational Programme Technologies and Applications for Competitiveness (OP TAC). Among these, the Digital Enterprise – Call I promotes SME digitalisation through investments in Industry 4.0 solutions—such as ICT systems, cybersecurity, digital twins, and connectivity infrastructure—which create a foundation for broader AI deployment. This initiative, with a budget of EUR 40.18 million (CZK 1 billion), attracted over 670 applicants in 2024, showing strong demand.

Complementing this, DEEP TECH – Call III provides targeted funding for industrial research and experimental development in advanced technologies, including AI, Big Data, 5G, and semiconductors. With EUR 120.53 million (CZK 3 billion) allocated, it aims to support up to 160 high-impact innovation projects capable of producing prototypes, digital solutions, or demonstrators. Depending on demand, additional funding may be mobilised to scale these efforts further. These combined measures are closely aligned with Czechia's updated AI ambitions and directly tackle key adoption barriers. Continuing to engage SMEs and maintain policy momentum will be essential to meeting national goals.

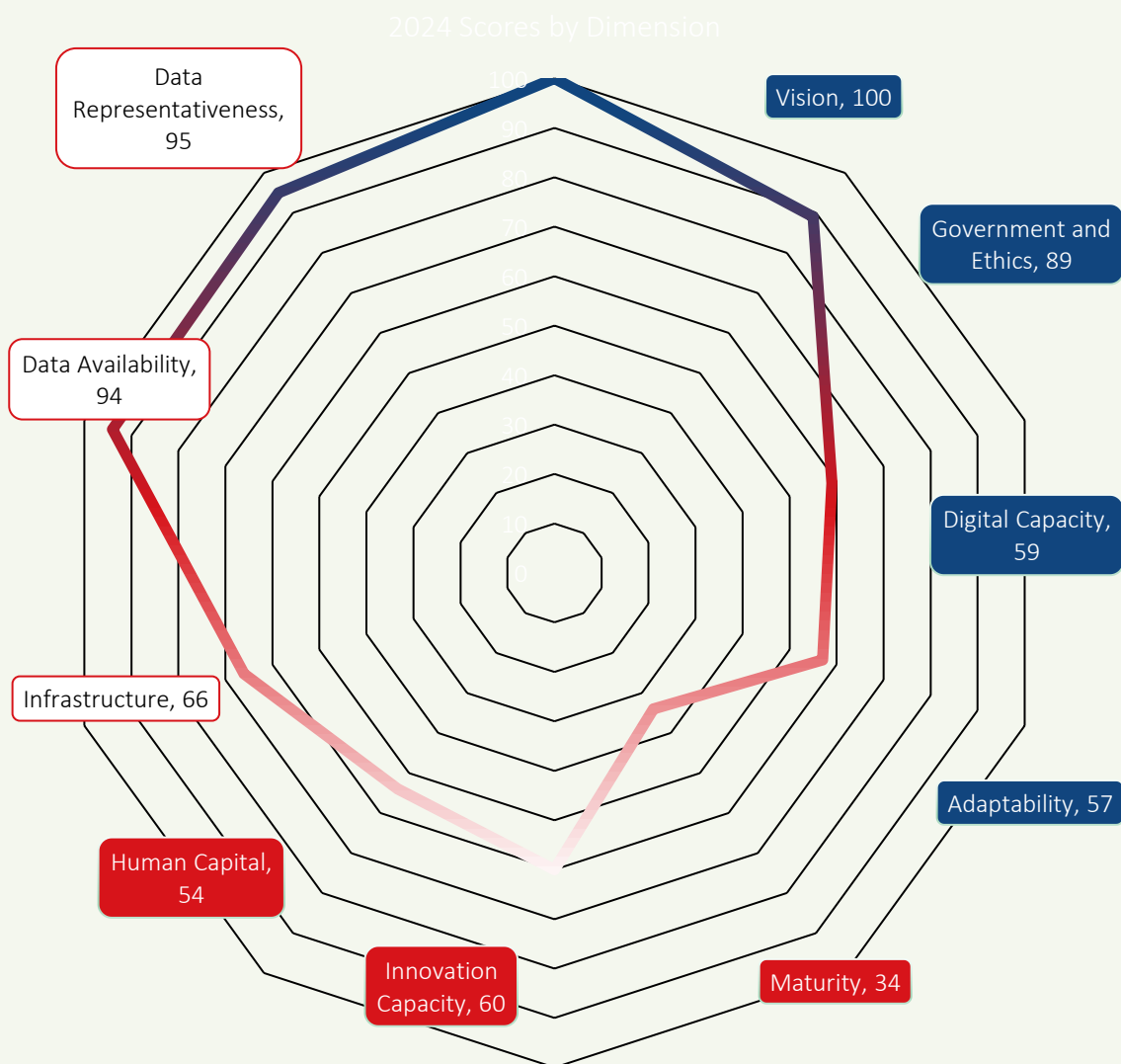
As part of the 2024 recommendation on accelerating AI, cloud, and data analytics uptake, Czechia was advised to assess the balance of its policy tools and to stimulate the use of next-generation cloud infrastructure across all business sizes—potentially through closer engagement with the Cloud IPCEI Exploitation Office or the IPCEI-CIS network. In response, Czechia incorporated new support actions into its revised roadmap, particularly through the Digital Enterprise Calls and DEEP TECH initiatives, both of which cover AI, cloud, and data analytics. While the country still trails the EU average in each of these areas, the near doubling of AI adoption in 2024 stands out as a major achievement. Although no specific collaboration with the Cloud IPCEI Exploitation Office has been reported, the roadmap does reinforce cloud adoption efforts. Overall, the 2024 actions represent a constructive—if not yet complete—response to the recommendation.





Government AI Readiness by Oxford Insights

'Eastern Europe ranks 4th in this year's Government AI Readiness Index, with an average score of 57.88—over 10 points above the global average (47.59). Estonia (72.62) leads the region and is the only Eastern European country to feature in the global top 25. The region performs above the global average across all three pillars. Its strongest performance is in the Data & Infrastructure pillar (72.10), making it the third-best performing region globally in this area. Eastern Europe also shows solid results in the Government pillar (62.52), where it again ranks third worldwide. However, the Technology Sector remains a challenge, with a regional score of 39.03—more than 20 points behind the other two pillars—and ranking fifth globally, falling narrowly behind the Middle East and North Africa (39.34). This reflects the need for further investment in technological capacity and innovation to unlock the region's full AI readiness potential. Eastern Europe's strong governance frameworks and robust data infrastructure continue to drive its progress, positioning it as a leader among emerging regions in AI readiness.'





Government

Czechia scores 76.45 in the Government pillar, reflecting its strong institutional alignment with EU-level AI governance and a proactive national strategy. The National Artificial Intelligence Strategy 2030 (NAIS 2030) lays the foundation for responsible AI development, integrating priorities such as digital transformation, public sector innovation, and AI ethics. While Czechia does not currently enforce standalone AI legislation, it is focused on the successful implementation of the EU AI Act, including setting up enforcement mechanisms, regulatory sandboxes, and market oversight bodies. Inter-ministerial coordination—led by the Ministry of Industry and Trade and supported by the Ministry of Labor and Social Affairs—ensures a whole-of-government approach that emphasizes societal preparedness, rights protection, and technological resilience.

Technology Sector

Czechia's Technology pillar score of 49.50 indicates a moderate but developing innovation environment. While the country has a strong academic foundation and a growing number of AI startups, the broader ecosystem still faces challenges in attracting large-scale private investment, scaling deep-tech ventures, and translating research into commercial applications. National initiatives support SMEs and startups, particularly through testing environments and innovation funding, but further momentum is needed to elevate Czechia's AI competitiveness. Strengthening public-private collaboration, expanding access to advanced computing, and deepening R&D-commercialization pipelines will be critical to unlocking greater technological dynamism.



Data & Infrastructure Sector

With a high Data & Infrastructure pillar score of 84.74, Czechia ranks among the global frontrunners in this domain. The country benefits from robust digital infrastructure, effective GDPR-aligned data protection frameworks, and increasing integration with European data-sharing initiatives. The NAIS 2030 emphasizes secure, interoperable, and ethical data use, laying the groundwork for trustworthy AI applications. National strategies also target the expansion of cloud computing and big data capabilities, aiming for at least 75% business adoption by 2030. These investments provide a strong backbone for AI development, supporting scalable, privacy-preserving innovation across sectors.



Conclusion

Czechia's artificial intelligence (AI) ecosystem is entering a key phase of its development, with foundational efforts focused on ensuring digital transformation, institutional readiness, and aligning with EU regulatory frameworks. Guided by the forthcoming EU AI Act and the National AI Strategy (NAIS 2030), Czechia is shaping a sustainable and human-centric AI landscape. The government's proactive approach includes key initiatives such as the creation of a National AI Taskforce and the establishment of AI governance structures that align with European values and ensure the ethical deployment of AI technologies.

However, significant challenges persist, particularly in scaling AI innovation beyond research and pilot projects. While more than 50 organizations are piloting AI technologies in sectors like healthcare, manufacturing, and finance, broader adoption, especially among small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs), remains slow. Czechia must bridge the gaps in AI infrastructure, technical capacity, and market expansion to realize AI's full potential. Strong digital infrastructure, such as the EU-supported data center initiative, positions the country as a regional AI and data gateway, but high-performance computing (HPC) and sector-specific data-sharing platforms are still in development. Regulatory sandboxes and open data initiatives show promise, but further investment is needed to create secure, accessible data environments for SMEs and researchers.

Czechia's regulatory approach follows a compliance-forward model aligned with the EU AI Act, focusing on implementing the act's provisions rather than creating standalone national legislation. Instead, Czechia leverages existing frameworks such as the Civil Code, the Act on Personal Data Processing (aligned with GDPR), and the Cybersecurity Act to oversee data protection, cybersecurity, and consumer rights. While these laws don't directly regulate AI governance, they significantly impact AI practices, particularly in areas like privacy protection and consumer rights.

Talent development is a crucial area of focus for Czechia. The government has launched initiatives to support AI-specific education and digital upskilling, with an emphasis on lifelong learning. However, there is a shortage of applied AI engineers and cross-sector deployment skills. Efforts to expand vocational training, reskilling, and cross-disciplinary education must scale to meet the growing demand for AI expertise across industries. Moreover, facilitating access to regulatory sandboxes, boosting research partnerships, and supporting SMEs with targeted funding and accelerators are vital steps toward a more interconnected and resilient innovation ecosystem. On the global stage, Czechia is an active player in European and global AI standard-setting bodies, such as ISO/IEC and CEN/CENELEC. The country aligns with the OECD AI Principles and contributes to EU working groups, reinforcing its commitment to cooperative, rights-based AI governance. Czechia's focus on ethical, human-centric AI development complements broader European digital goals, with the country positioning itself as a leader in AI innovation in the heart of Europe.

In conclusion, Czechia is well-positioned to become a regional leader in AI development, with a strategy that balances regulatory compliance, innovation, and societal trust. Continued commitment to EU-aligned regulation, responsible AI deployment, and inclusive capacity-building will enable the country to scale its AI ecosystem and achieve its long-term digital transformation goals.





Appendix A: Expert Vignettes



David Spacil

AI-Driven Content Creator



“

*“AI is not the end of creativity, but a new beginning.
The rules have changed, unlocking vast opportunities for
those embracing human-AI synergy to
redefine artistic potential.”*



”

Biography

David Spacil, also known as **Havran**, is a leading expert at the intersection of AI and creative industries, with over **20 years of experience** in video and digital marketing. He is the founder of [Rules have changed](#), a platform and international conference dedicated to exploring new horizons for creators through AI. Awarded [Czech AI Personality of 2024 in Culture](#), David champions human-AI synergy, educating creatives on leveraging AI tools for innovation and artistic expression.



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Karel Firley

Hewlett Packard Enterprise



“

*From my perspective, despite Czechia's strong academic foundation and a growing number of AI startups, the country continues to face challenges in attracting large-scale private investment. **High upfront costs and limited access to experimentation environments** remain significant barriers for SMEs. While **high-performance computing installations** offer promising opportunities for AI training and workforce reskilling, **access to these resources is still restricted**, limiting their broader impact.*



”

Biography

Karel Firley, driven by a passion for emerging technologies, business innovation, and strategic planning, Karel helps clients identify and implement right solutions for their unique needs. He is a change advocate, a global traveler, and a challenger of the status quo.



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Jan Suchan

Tech Leaders Mastermind



“

“A strong understanding of AI technology, combined with uniquely human qualities like empathy, creativity, and genuine connection, is what will distinguish average teams from great ones.”



”

Biography

Jan Suchan, is an engineering leader with 15+ years in technology and leadership at companies like Avast and Pure Storage, where he built and led over ten development teams. He mentors startup founders, serves as a fractional/interim CTO, and facilitates Mastermind sessions for the techleader.cz community, bringing together founders, CTOs, and other tech leaders to share insights and learn from each other, with AI often on the agenda.



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